CASE STUDY

Phishing is an online offense where the cybercriminal sends an email, SMS, or call posing as a trusted organization, tricking the victim into divulging crucial information such as the password, PIN, OTP, or card details. Pragyan, a college student, receives an urgent message on his email, claiming his bank account will be blocked if he doesn't verify his account within 24 hours. The message has the bank's logo, uses formal language, and has a link to the bank's official website. Pragyan, being worried about losing access to his account, clicks on the link. The cybercriminal's fake website looks exactly the same as the bank's official website, asking for Pragyan's username, password, and OTP. Pragyan, thinking he's being cautious, enters all the details. Immediately, the information is sent to the cybercriminal, who logs into Pragyan's actual bank account and transfers all his savings to another account. Phishing attacks are commonly perpetrated on students, working professionals, or elderly citizens, as they are most likely to react impulsively to the message. The cybercrime has significant implications for Pragyan, such as losing his savings, anxiety, guilt, time spent visiting the bank, getting his card blocked, and filing complaints with cybercrime authorities.